Genealogy Research Log Plugin

Getting started: install once, then turn any ancestor into a sourced research log

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Genealogy class handout

1. What you need

- A **paid Claude plan** (Pro or Max). Plugins and Claude in Chrome are paid features; see claude.com/pricing.
- The **Claude desktop app** for Mac or Windows, from claude.ai/download.
- **Google Chrome** on the same computer.
- A free **FamilySearch** account, plus any subscriptions you already have (Ancestry, Findmypast, MyHeritage and others).
- Optional: **LibreOffice** (free) to make PDFs on your own computer.

2. Install the plugin

1. Open the Claude desktop app and sign in.
2. In the left sidebar, click **Customize**, then the **Plugins** tab.
3. Click **Add** → **Add marketplace** → **Add from a repository**.
4. Type `dgheaps9/genealogy-research-log` and confirm.
5. Open the new marketplace and install **genealogy-research-log**.



When installed, it appears under **From marketplaces you added**. Free under the MIT License.

3. Run the setup guide (one time, about 30–45 minutes)

OPEN A NEW CHAT AND TYPE

> *Set up genealogy research.*

Claude walks you through each step, one at a time, and checks that it worked:

1. Install **Claude in Chrome** and sign in with your Claude account.
2. Sign in to each genealogy site in Chrome. **You type your own passwords**; Claude never sees them.
3. Choose a **Genealogy folder** on your computer. Claude adds the subfolders and the research-log toolkit.
4. Create a **Claude Project** (for example "Family Search") and paste in the instructions Claude fills out for you.
5. Run a first test on an ancestor you know well.

4. Research an ancestor

1. Open Chrome and check you are still signed in to your sites.
2. Open a chat **inside your genealogy Project** and type the name, PID and birth facts:

> *Research [full name] (PID [FamilySearch ID]), born [birth date] in [birth place]. Read the attached sources first, then search for new ones. Create the research log.*

3. Leave Chrome alone while Claude reads the attached sources and searches the sites. You can watch.
4. Read the log, then make the Tree Actions yourself in FamilySearch.

Useful follow-ups: "What conflicts did you find?" · "Create a log for his wife too." · "Update the log for Fanny Busby."

5. What you get

A Word file and a PDF in your Genealogy folder, a copy in your Project, and an updated Research Tracker spreadsheet. Seven sections:

1. Identification
2. Vital Events, each rated **Proven** **Probable** **Possible**
3. Spouse(s)
4. Child(ren)
5. Sources, with full citations, a link for every source, and whether it is attached in FamilySearch
6. Research Notes, including every search performed
7. Tree Actions Suggested: step-by-step fixes, with the link you need at each step

Older versions are kept automatically in a Superseded folder.

Good to know

- **Claude never edits FamilySearch.** It suggests; you decide and make each change.
- **Open the original image** before changing your tree.
- **Protect the living:** their logs are marked "LIVING – do not upload to Memories".
- **Site terms are yours to follow.** Claude uses your own logins, one person at a time.
- **Long sessions use more of your plan's allowance.** Heavy researchers may prefer Max.
- **Stuck?** Send Claude a screenshot of what you see.